

The Coastal Weather Station

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The weather station sits on a low cliff above the harbour, where the wind arrives without anything to slow it down. Every morning at six, the technicians climb the metal stairs to check the instruments and record the overnight readings by hand.

The anemometer turns freely in the salt air, and the rain gauge is cleared of sand before the first measurements of the day are logged. Visibility is estimated from a set of markers placed along the breakwater at fixed distances.

How the Data Travels

Readings are stored locally on a small computer and then forwarded to the regional office over a mobile connection. When the signal is weak, the station keeps the data and retries every few minutes until the link recovers, so no observation is ever lost.

A second copy is written to a removable card each evening. The card is collected once a week by a courier who also brings spare parts and the printed maintenance schedule for the coming days.

Why It Matters

Fishermen rely on the station's short-range forecast before leaving the bay, and the harbour master uses the wind records to decide when small vessels should stay in port. Accurate, continuous data is the difference between a routine day and a dangerous one.

Over the years the archive has grown into a detailed picture of how the local climate is changing, and researchers now visit the station to compare its long records with satellite measurements.